in Bharuch.[14] They formed 7 per cent of Bombay's population, which exceeded 7,00,000. They were quite a settled population by then as 70 per cent of them were born in the city. In Bombay, twenty-six of the forty-six shipbuilders and boat-makers, and thirty-three of the eighty-four civilian engineers, were Parsis. Not a single Parsi was enlisted in the army, a fact perhaps compensated for several decades later when Sam Manekshaw commanded India to victory in the Indo–Pak war of 1971. Some 3000 Parsis outside British India, many in the trading ports of China, and 8000 people in Persia were said to profess the ancient Zoroastrian faith.

Over the next century, the size of the Parsi population in India would peak at over a 1,00,000 in 1941 and then remarkably *decline* to less than 60,000 today according to the most recent Census. The factors for this decline include low fertility, outmigration to other countries combined with little internal migration and conservative Parsi community laws on interreligious marriage. What Karaka had written in 1884 still holds true—the Parsis are probably the smallest community in the world today—but one can add that as long as Bombay House, Tata's head office, remains powerful, they will always be in the news.

Chettiar Credits

Chettinad in south India is famous for exporting its mouth-watering cuisine, which involves a rich variety of spices and curries, to major metropolitan kitchens around the world. The cuisine blends local ingredients and styles with those observed outside India. The kavuni arisi, a black sticky rice pudding, is said to have a Burmese flavour while the idiyappam, or string hopper, has a Sri Lankan influence. These multicultural adaptations occurred because Chettinad, home to less than a 100 villages, was until recently the headquarters of a large financial empire straddling both South and South East Asia.

Located in southern Tamil Nadu, Chettinad lies in a region spanning the erstwhile princely state of Pudukkottai and Ramnad district. It is the land of the Nakarattar or Nattukkottai Chettiars, a prominent merchant–banking